

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Carpentry & Remodeling English



Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Carpenters, remodelers, finish carpenters, joinery installers, and carpentry crew leads.

Original fictional language practice, not carpentry instruction, structural assessment, legal advice, or a statement of code or permit requirements. All dimensions, incidents, quotations, products, and schedules in exercises are invented. Structural decisions, hazardous materials, tool use, installation methods, and site safety require qualified people and project-specific procedures. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of these cases.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

- 01 The survey note and the door schedule
- 02 Matching old oak without promising an exact twin
- 03 An old detail inside a new email
- 04 A wall that may not be straight
- 05 One extra room, two possible packages
- 06 A handover between the floor and cabinet teams
- 07 A finish concern after the review meeting
- 08 The owner needs a useful final record

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

Original fictional language practice, not carpentry instruction, structural assessment, legal advice, or a statement of code or permit requirements. All dimensions, incidents, quotations, products, and schedules in exercises are invented. Structural decisions, hazardous materials, tool use, installation methods, and site safety require qualified people and project-specific procedures. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of these cases.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

The survey note and the door schedule

A carpenter and designer reconcile references for a utility-room door without selecting an installation method.

Roles: Carpenter / Designer

Carpenter: The utility door schedule shows a unit width, while the survey labels an opening. Can we reconcile them?

Designer: Yes. Which drawing revision and survey location are you using for that comparison this morning?

Carpenter: Revision C, doorway U2. The survey was taken before the wall finishes were added on either side.

Designer: Then the survey dimension describes an earlier condition. The schedule refers to the proposed door unit itself.

Carpenter: The client has asked for the usable passage width, so neither number answers that question directly.

Designer: Correct. We need the completed opening relationship, including the selected frame, before confirming usable width to them.

Carpenter: Could you issue a marked detail identifying the datum and the surfaces for each dimension?

Designer: I can prepare that clarification. Please keep the supplier's order on hold while I reconcile the documents.

Carpenter: I will. Should I tell the client the proposed door is unsuitable for their delivery trolley?

Designer: Not yet; suitability hasn't been established either way. Ask for the trolley's actual dimensions and turning requirements.

Carpenter: They can provide those today. I'll identify them as client requirements, not alter your drawing myself.

Designer: Good. Send them with the survey, and we'll answer the passage question against one coordinated detail.

Notice the professional language

'Neither number answers that question' separates two valid measurements from the client's different requirement.

'Hasn't been established either way' avoids turning uncertainty into a rejection.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Matching old oak without promising an exact twin

A remodeling carpenter and homeowner discuss new shelving beside existing oak paneling.

Roles: Carpenter / Homeowner

Carpenter: The new oak sample is close in color, but its grain differs from the paneling you are retaining.

Homeowner: I noticed that. Can the supplier guarantee an exact match if we choose a more expensive board?

Carpenter: Price alone wouldn't establish that. Wood varies, and the existing finish has its own age and appearance.

Homeowner: I mainly want the shelves to look intentional, rather than like a failed attempt at matching.

Carpenter: Then we can compare a close match with a deliberate contrast, using actual samples beside the paneling.

Homeowner: Would a contrasting finish mean changing the shelf profile as well, or only the visible surface?

Carpenter: Only the surface in these options. Both examples retain the agreed square edge and the same dimensions.

Homeowner: The darker sample looks deliberate. I would like to see it under our evening lighting before deciding.

Carpenter: I'll leave the labeled sample here and keep the material selection open until tomorrow.

Homeowner: Please make sure the workshop doesn't treat our discussion as approval to start making the shelves.

Carpenter: I'll tell them color review is pending. The profile remains agreed, but the finish is not selected.

Homeowner: Thank you. Tomorrow I'll choose between these two references, rather than asking for an impossible identical grain.

Notice the professional language

'A deliberate contrast' offers a positive alternative to a poorly defined exact match.

'The profile remains agreed' preserves a settled decision while isolating the open finish choice.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

An old detail inside a new email

A carpenter and cabinet supplier discover that an attachment does not match its covering email.

Roles: Carpenter / Supplier

Carpenter: Your email says revised for approval, but the attached section still has the original drawer-front arrangement.

Supplier: That's unexpected. Are you comparing the attachment with the elevation we discussed during yesterday's review meeting?

Carpenter: Yes. The elevation shows two equal fronts; this section still labels three different front heights.

Supplier: I may have attached the earlier file. Please tell me the revision letter printed on its border.

Carpenter: It says A, while your email refers to C. I haven't released the cabinet to fabrication.

Supplier: Thank you for catching that. I'll resend the correct section and identify the superseded attachment clearly.

Carpenter: Please include the matching elevation too, so the workshop receives one coordinated set rather than isolated sheets.

Supplier: I can issue those together. Does the client need to reconsider the finish sample as part of this?

Carpenter: No, the finish hasn't changed. This query concerns the drawer arrangement and the documents describing it.

Supplier: Understood. I'll keep the finish approval reference and show the drawing correction as a separate change.

Carpenter: Once I receive the set, I'll compare the section and elevation before confirming its review status.

Supplier: That works. The earlier email remains a record of transmission, not evidence that the incorrect attachment was approved.

Notice the professional language

finish sample - A physical example used to compare a proposed surface color, sheen, or texture.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A wall that may not be straight

A carpenter and homeowner discuss uneven visible spacing beside a proposed built-in unit.

Roles: Carpenter / Homeowner

Carpenter: The survey shows different widths at the front and rear of this alcove.

Homeowner: Does that mean the wall is unsound? The old bookcase always looked slightly crooked here.

Carpenter: Different widths alone don't establish structural condition. They tell us the space is not uniform at those points.

Homeowner: I see. My main concern is the cabinet looking straight when we view it from the doorway.

Carpenter: That's an appearance requirement we can discuss. The drawing needs to show the face line and adjoining relationship.

Homeowner: Can you promise the visible gap will disappear completely once the cabinet is fitted into the alcove?

Carpenter: Not without an agreed detail. A scribed panel might be considered, but design review comes first.

Homeowner: Then please ask for a detail that shows what remains visible, not just the overall cabinet width.

Carpenter: I'll do that and include the actual survey points so the designer has the same information.

Homeowner: Will the new detail mean another charge, or is it part of the existing cabinet proposal?

Carpenter: The project manager needs to clarify that scope question. I can describe the issue, not decide the commercial terms.

Homeowner: Please arrange both clarifications together. I'll hold my appearance approval until I can see the proposed finished relationship.

Notice the professional language

'Different widths alone' limits the inference to the actual measurement evidence.

'That's an appearance requirement' acknowledges the client's priority without substituting it for a structural assessment.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

One extra room, two possible packages

A remodeling carpenter and owner discuss extending a trim package to a second room.

Roles: Carpenter / Owner

Carpenter: You asked about adding the dining room. The current package covers the sitting room only.

Owner: Yes. I'd like matching trim in both, but I need a useful comparison before deciding.

Carpenter: We can quote the dining room separately or request a combined revision covering both rooms.

Owner: Would the combined revision automatically include repainting the doors as well as the new trim?

Carpenter: No. We should list door painting explicitly if you want it included in that comparison.

Owner: Please include it as a separate line. I might keep the existing door finish after all.

Carpenter: I'll distinguish trim supply, fitting, and the requested decorating extent, with timing for each proposed package.

Owner: The estimate has an allowance. Doesn't that mean the extra room is already partly paid for?

Carpenter: That allowance is identified for the sitting-room trim selection, not an unspecified amount of extra work.

Owner: Understood. Keep that reference visible so I can compare the original scope with the proposed addition.

Carpenter: I will ask for the difference to be shown clearly, without treating either proposal as accepted.

Owner: Then I'll review both packages with the decorator before approving any extension of the work.

Notice the professional language

'As a separate line' requests a visible scope distinction within a quotation.

'Not an unspecified amount of extra work' clarifies an allowance without interpreting contractual rights.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A handover between the floor and cabinet teams

A carpenter and flooring supervisor settle the boundaries of an upcoming room release.

Roles: Carpenter / Flooring supervisor

Carpenter: The lookahead says kitchen available Friday. Does that mean your work and room release are both complete?

Flooring supervisor: Our floor installation is planned to finish Friday, but the room-release conditions still need confirmation.

Carpenter: Thanks. The phrase available sounded broader than that when the cabinet supplier read the schedule yesterday.

Flooring supervisor: I understand. We should replace it with a clear status, including what remains to be checked.

Carpenter: Can you give the coordinator that distinction today? The delivery booking needs a decision tomorrow morning.

Flooring supervisor: Yes. I'll report installation timing separately from access release and name the person confirming the latter.

Carpenter: The supplier also asks whether their delivery route crosses the retained hallway finish beside the kitchen.

Flooring supervisor: It does. That interface belongs in the protection discussion, rather than being left to the delivery crew.

Carpenter: I'll include it in the coordination call, with the agreed hallway restrictions visible to everyone attending.

Flooring supervisor: Good. Please avoid telling the client the cabinets are delayed by flooring before the options are reviewed.

Carpenter: Agreed. Let's confirm access and check the delivery options before saying the flooring team has delayed us.

Flooring supervisor: Then our update will identify the open release condition and tomorrow's booking decision without assigning unsupported blame.

Notice the professional language

'The phrase ... sounded broader' repairs an interpretation without accusing the other trade.

'Separately from access release' distinguishes finishing an activity from authorizing the next crew's access.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A finish concern after the review meeting

A carpenter and client agree how to handle a new snag reported after an earlier walkthrough.

Roles: Carpenter / Client

Carpenter: You sent a photograph after yesterday's walkthrough. Which feature would you like reviewed?

Client: The joint above the left corner looks uneven in daylight, although I didn't notice it last evening.

Carpenter: Thank you. I'll identify that joint and the lighting difference rather than say the entire trim failed.

Client: Will raising it now cancel the other items we agreed were satisfactory during the walkthrough?

Carpenter: Not automatically in our review record. We can keep those observations and add this specific concern separately.

Client: I'd like that. The rest of the room looks good, and I don't want the issue exaggerated.

Carpenter: Do you have the original image available? The messaging app preview makes the corner hard to see.

Client: Yes, I'll send the full image and indicate the left corner on a second copy for orientation.

Carpenter: I'll ask the joinery lead to review it against the detail, with the cause and remedy still open.

Client: Please include me in the appointment. I want to show the exact view before anything is proposed.

Carpenter: Thursday at ten is available for that review. Is that suitable for you to attend in person?

Client: Yes. Confirm Thursday's review, and describe it as the window-joint concern rather than a complete room rejection.

Notice the professional language

'Add this specific concern separately' preserves earlier decisions while allowing new evidence.

'For orientation' explains why a marked copy accompanies the original photograph.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

The owner needs a useful final record

A carpenter and facilities representative review a remodeled meeting room's handover pack.

Roles: Carpenter / Facilities representative

Carpenter: The pack contains cabinet records, finish references, and supplier documents. One trim item remains open.

Facilities representative: Which item? I need to explain the room status to our incoming colleague.

Carpenter: The short molding beside the store door is awaiting replacement. Everything else on this list has been reviewed.

Facilities representative: Please keep review status separate from warranty terms; our incoming colleague sometimes confuses them.

Carpenter: I will. The warranty document is separate, and any coverage question should refer to its actual terms.

Facilities representative: Is the molding's return visit booked, or are we still waiting for the supplier to confirm availability?

Carpenter: Availability is still pending. Joel owns the follow-up and has agreed to update you on Monday afternoon.

Facilities representative: Can the incoming colleague be included, so the handover doesn't depend on forwarding my messages later?

Carpenter: Yes. With your agreed contact details, I'll include them and ask them to acknowledge receipt of the pack.

Facilities representative: Their name is Lena. I'll introduce her today and explain that the molding remains an open item.

Carpenter: Then Monday's update will go to both of you, without presenting the room record as a completion guarantee.

Facilities representative: Lena will have the documents, the open item, and a named contact to follow up with.

Notice the professional language

warranty document - A document stating the provider's warranty terms and conditions for identified work or products.

return visit - A planned later attendance to review or complete identified outstanding work.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Confirming openings and measurement references

SHARED CASE

The hall drawing labels a door opening 900 millimeters. The client assumes this is clear passage width. The note does not say rough or finished opening; no door has been ordered. The designer can clarify the reference.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish a client's usable-space requirement from a drawing dimension. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are the client. You need the usable passage clarified and have not chosen a door unit.

Useful expressions

Is ___ measured between ___ or ___?

When you say clear width, do you mean ___?

We have the dimension, but still need ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

The drawing gives 900 millimeters, but it does not identify the measurement surfaces. Do you need that as the clear passage width, or were you referring to the framed opening? I will ask the designer to confirm the datum and jamb allowance before we treat this dimension as an order size.

Second round

The designer confirms a rough opening, but the client still asks whether a large cabinet will fit. Separate the two measurements.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

SHARED CASE

For a fictional study remodel, sample A is solid oak trim with pronounced grain and a ten-day quoted lead time. Sample B is oak-veneered trim with a more uniform appearance and a four-day quoted lead time. Both match the requested profile. No sample is selected.

Role A | Responding professional

Compare two finish choices without treating one feature as an overall verdict. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are the client. You prefer visible grain but need to understand the supply difference.

Useful expressions

Both samples ___, whereas only ___.

The difference in appearance is ___.

The quoted lead time is ___; the site date remains ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Both samples match the requested profile. Sample A has more pronounced grain and a quoted ten-day lead time, whereas sample B looks more uniform and is quoted at four days. Those are appearance and supply differences, not a general quality ranking. Which appearance would you like us to use as the reference?

Second round

The supplier revises A's lead time to twelve days. Recompare the options without changing the client's appearance preference.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

SHARED CASE

Cabinet elevation C4 revision B shows a 20-millimeter reveal. Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters at the same end panel. Fabrication release is due for review at 14:00. The designer has not clarified which dimension applies.

Role A | Responding professional

Request a specific clarification with references, location, and consequence. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are the designer. Ask for the two drawing references and the affected component.

Useful expressions

On ___ revision ___, the dimension is ___ .

Could you reconcile ___ with ___?

This affects ___; please confirm ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could you clarify the end-panel reveal before our 14:00 fabrication review? Elevation C4 revision B shows 20 millimeters, while section S2 revision B shows 15 at the same location. Please identify the intended dimension and the drawing that needs correction. We will keep this panel out of fabrication release until the conflict is resolved.

Second round

You can answer only at 15:00. Agree how the panel's release status will be described at the 14:00 review.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

SHARED CASE

An existing exposed subfloor has dark staining beside the laundry doorway. The client asks whether the joists are rotten. The carpenter has not assessed structural condition and the joists are not visible. The project lead can arrange a qualified assessment.

Role A | Responding professional

Report a concealed-condition concern without diagnosing damage or minimizing it. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are the client. Ask whether visible staining necessarily means structural decay.

Useful expressions

I can see ___ at ___.

That does not establish whether ___.

The assessment needs to address ___ before ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

The dark staining is visible on the subfloor beside the laundry doorway. It does not tell me the condition of the joists underneath, which are not visible. I cannot confirm decay or its cause from this observation. I will ask the project lead to arrange an assessment before we discuss any resulting scope change.

Second round

The client remembers an old spill. Attribute that recollection without treating it as the confirmed explanation.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Separating requested extras from agreed work

SHARED CASE

The agreed bedroom scope includes replacing skirting only. The client requests a built-in bench; decorating is excluded. The carpenter can arrange a separate quotation, but no bench dimensions, price, or completion date are agreed.

Role A | Responding professional

Discuss an extra without silently adding it to the existing price. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are the client. You want storage in the bench but have not chosen its size.

Useful expressions

The current scope includes ___ and excludes ___ .

We can retain ___ or request a price for ___ .

If you choose ___, we still need to agree ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

The current bedroom scope covers skirting replacement and excludes decorating. A built-in bench would be an addition. We can keep the present scope or obtain a separate quotation for the bench, including any making good. If you want that comparison, we first need your intended size; its price and timing remain open.

Second round

The client adds matching wall paneling. Identify it as another item to assess, not an assumed part of the bench.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Coordinating access and other trades

SHARED CASE

The joinery delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning. The decorator has not released the study for carpentry access. The hallway is available for a separate trim review at 11:00, but not for material storage. The site coordinator needs the current status.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish a confirmed delivery from an available work area. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are the coordinator. Confirm the delivery but ask which area is actually available.

Useful expressions

Delivery is confirmed for __; access remains __.

The next activity depends on __.

That window covers __, not __.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Tuesday morning's joinery delivery is confirmed, but study access is still awaiting the decorator's release. The hallway is available for the 11:00 trim review only, not storage. Please confirm the study access window before we sequence the fitting work. I will ask the supplier about delivery flexibility while that dependency remains open.

Second round

The decorator releases the study for Wednesday morning. Discuss what still needs checking with the supplier.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

SHARED CASE

At a wardrobe review you said all fronts were flush. The client points to drawer D3, whose left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. You have not assessed the cause or remedy. Correct your earlier statement and add the specific observation for follow-up.

Role A | Responding professional

Repair an overstatement while agreeing a precise finish-review description. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are the client. Identify D3's left edge and ask that it remain visible in the snag record.

Useful expressions

My earlier statement about ___ was too broad.

At ___, the edge is ___ relative to ___.

The recorded observation is ___; the remedy remains ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

My earlier statement that all the fronts were flush was too broad. At drawer D3, the left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. I will add that observation to the snag list and ask the joinery lead to review it. We have identified the appearance issue, but have not yet agreed its cause or remedy.

Second round

The joinery lead cannot attend until Thursday. Agree the review appointment without promising a same-day remedy.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Handing over records and return visits

SHARED CASE

The owner receives cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet. A replacement shelf pin cover is due but not delivered. The joinery lead, Mina, accepts supplier follow-up and will call Friday. The return-visit date is not confirmed; warranty terms remain those in the supplied document.

Role A | Responding professional

Give the owner usable records and an identifiable follow-up contact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are the owner. Ask who will follow up and whether Friday is an installation date.

Useful expressions

This document covers ___, not ___.

___ has accepted follow-up for ___.

The update is due ___; the visit date is ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Here are the cabinet drawings and the care sheet for the finish actually supplied. The shelf pin cover is still outstanding. Mina has accepted supplier follow-up and will call you Friday with its status; the return-visit date is not yet confirmed. Please keep the supplied warranty document for its specific terms rather than relying on a general verbal promise.

Second round

The supplier changes the expected delivery. Explain the revised status without interpreting warranty coverage.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Nine hundred between which faces?

At the hall doorway, the carpenter and client clarify the fictional 900-millimeter note.

01 • Carpenter: The hall drawing says nine hundred millimeters. Were you expecting that much clear passage?

02 • Client: Yes, our cabinet needs that space, and I thought the number guaranteed it.

03 • Carpenter: The note doesn't say whether it measures the rough opening or finished opening.

04 • Client: I hadn't realized those were different. Does the jamb take up some space?

05 • Carpenter: The frame and open door affect usable passage; we need the selected unit's dimensions.

06 • Client: We haven't chosen the door yet. Can you still clarify the drawing today?

07 • Carpenter: I can ask the designer which surfaces the number refers to before ordering.

08 • Client: Please mention the cabinet, because usable width is the requirement that matters most.

09 • Carpenter: I'll separate your passage requirement from the unresolved drawing dimension in that question.

10 • Client: That helps. Let's leave the order pending until those two things agree.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The floor that is not finished yet

A carpenter checks a cabinet-height reference with the site coordinator.

01 • Carpenter: Your cabinet sketch gives a height, but which floor surface is the datum?

02 • Site coordinator: The finished floor should be the reference, not the exposed subfloor visible today.

03 • Carpenter: Thanks. The supplier's survey note says existing floor, which could mean something different.

04 • Site coordinator: That survey happened before the floor finish was selected. I see the problem.

05 • Carpenter: Could you confirm the current floor build-up with the designer before fabrication release?

06 • Site coordinator: Yes, and I'll ask them to identify the finished floor reference on the sketch.

07 • Carpenter: Please keep the earlier survey attached so the supplier can see what changed.

08 • Site coordinator: Should I describe the old height as wrong, or simply as needing reconciliation?

09 • Carpenter: Needing reconciliation is more accurate; the two documents may use different reference surfaces.

10 • Site coordinator: I'll request a coordinated dimension, with fabrication release still pending that response.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A width without its units

A carpenter and supplier resolve an ambiguous shelf enquiry by telephone.

01 • Carpenter: Your quotation lists the alcove shelf as thirty, but it doesn't show units.

02 • Supplier: That's thirty inches of nominal width. Were you reading the number as centimeters?

03 • Carpenter: I was checking because our site measurements are recorded in millimeters throughout this job.

04 • Supplier: Understood. Is your figure the wall opening or the finished shelf length requested?

05 • Carpenter: It's the opening measurement; the shelf size still needs confirmation against the detail.

06 • Supplier: Then I shouldn't simply convert thirty inches and treat that as your order.

07 • Carpenter: Exactly. Please label the quotation dimension and wait for the confirmed fabrication size.

08 • Supplier: I can revise the description now without releasing any material to the workshop.

09 • Carpenter: Please also retain the unit labels when you send the revised quotation over.

10 • Supplier: Done. It will say nominal width in inches, with fabrication dimensions awaiting confirmation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Confirming openings and measurement references

The hall drawing labels a door opening 900 millimeters. The client assumes this is clear passage width. The note does not say rough or finished opening; no door has been ordered. The designer can clarify the reference.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. You need the usable passage clarified and have not chosen a door unit.

Second round: The designer confirms a rough opening, but the client still asks whether a large cabinet will fit. Separate the two measurements.

Scenario 2 | The alcove narrows at the back

An alcove survey records front width 1,210 millimeters and rear width 1,190 millimeters. A client calls it a 1,200-millimeter opening. No shelf fabrication size is approved.

Role A: Carpenter: distinguish the two measured locations from the shorthand description.

Role B: Client: you want full-depth shelves and can show the survey sketch.

Possible opening: Is twelve hundred the front measurement, the back measurement, or a rounded description?

Success checks

- Name both locations and dimensions aloud.
- Explain why an average is not a confirmed fabrication size.
- Agree who will clarify the shelf detail before ordering.

Add a complication: The client says a single average would be simpler for the order.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Choosing the study trim reference

At a sample review, a carpenter and client compare the two study trim options.

- 01 • Carpenter:** Both samples match your trim profile. Which difference catches your eye in this light?
- 02 • Client:** Sample A has stronger grain. Is sample B a different shape around the edge?
- 03 • Carpenter:** No, the shape matches. B has an oak veneer and a more uniform appearance.
- 04 • Client:** I prefer A's grain, but the room is needed soon. What about delivery?
- 05 • Carpenter:** The supplier quotes ten days for A and four for B at present.
- 06 • Client:** Does choosing B mean the entire study will be finished six days earlier?
- 07 • Carpenter:** Not necessarily. Those figures concern supply; the site schedule also includes other work.
- 08 • Client:** Then keep A as my preferred sample while you check the scheduling effect.
- 09 • Carpenter:** I'll label it preferred, with the timing decision open, rather than as an order.
- 10 • Client:** Yes, show me that effect before we make the final selection for the room.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

White is not a complete finish description

A carpenter and decorator compare a trim sample with an existing painted surface.

01 • Carpenter: The client asked for white trim, but this sample looks glossier than the existing skirting.

02 • Decorator: The color reference matches. The sheen is different, which changes how light reflects.

03 • Carpenter: Could we show both together before calling this a successful finish match today?

04 • Decorator: Certainly. Is the client asking for the same color or the same overall appearance?

05 • Carpenter: Their note says match existing, so I think we need to clarify both.

06 • Decorator: I'll bring a lower-sheen sample with the same color reference for the comparison.

07 • Carpenter: Please identify the sample labels; photographs alone have made the difference hard to judge.

08 • Decorator: Agreed. We can compare them in the room under the same lighting conditions.

09 • Carpenter: Then I'll ask the client to choose a physical reference rather than another vague description.

10 • Decorator: That gives us a specific appearance target without promising every surface will look identical.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The molding is wide enough but different

A carpenter questions a supplier's proposed replacement molding.

01 • Carpenter: The replacement molding is the right width, but the curve doesn't match our sample.

02 • Supplier: Our stock description lists the same overall dimensions. Which feature differs from yours?

03 • Carpenter: The original has a small bead at the edge; the replacement has a flat edge.

04 • Supplier: I see it now in your reference photo. So width alone isn't the issue.

05 • Carpenter: Correct. This piece sits beside retained trim, so the profile difference will be visible.

06 • Supplier: Would you like another stock sample or a quotation for a matching profile?

07 • Carpenter: Please quote the matching profile first, with its lead time shown separately from price.

08 • Supplier: I can do that. The stock alternative can remain available for the client's comparison.

09 • Carpenter: Label it alternative, please, so nobody mistakes it for an accepted substitution on delivery.

10 • Supplier: I'll update the enquiry to show profile match required, with the alternative clearly identified.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

For a fictional study remodel, sample A is solid oak trim with pronounced grain and a ten-day quoted lead time. Sample B is oak-veneered trim with a more uniform appearance and a four-day quoted lead time. Both match the requested profile. No sample is selected.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. You prefer visible grain but need to understand the supply difference.

Second round: The supplier revises A's lead time to twelve days. Recompare the options without changing the client's appearance preference.

Scenario 2 | One sample, two directions

A client approves the color of a veneered cabinet sample but says nothing about grain direction. The elevation shows horizontal grain; the sample was displayed vertically.

Role A: Carpenter: clarify whether approval covers color, direction, or both.

Role B: Client: you like the color but prefer vertical grain and have not discussed a revised elevation.

Possible opening: Does your approval cover the color only, or also the grain direction shown here?

Success checks

- Separate sample approval from drawing revision.
- State the preferred direction in ordinary words.
- Keep production confirmation pending the reconciled elevation.

Add a complication: The client assumes turning the sample also changes the production drawing.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two dimensions on revision B

A carpenter calls the designer before the cabinet fabrication review.

01 • Carpenter: Could you clarify the end-panel reveal before our two o'clock fabrication review today?

02 • Designer: Which drawings disagree? I need their references and revisions to locate the issue.

03 • Carpenter: Elevation C4 shows twenty millimeters; section detail S2 shows fifteen. Both are revision B.

04 • Designer: Are those dimensions at the same end panel, or on opposite cabinet runs?

05 • Carpenter: The same panel beside the study doorway. I've marked that location on both.

06 • Designer: Thank you. I need to reconcile the detail, and I cannot answer before three.

07 • Carpenter: Then I'll keep that panel out of release at the two o'clock review.

08 • Designer: Please distinguish it from the other panels, which aren't part of this query.

09 • Carpenter: I will. Can your reply identify both the intended reveal and the drawing correction?

10 • Designer: Yes. My response will address those points, with the marked references attached for clarity.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Extra width is not an extra shelf

A carpenter explains a supplier's scribe allowance note to a client.

01 • Carpenter: The supplier's end panel is wider on the schedule than on your finished elevation.

02 • Client: That's what worried me. Will it make the cupboard stick farther into the room?

03 • Carpenter: The schedule includes a scribe allowance, meaning extra material for fitting the adjoining surface.

04 • Client: So the scheduled piece size is not necessarily the finished visible panel width?

05 • Carpenter: Exactly. We still need the detail to confirm how that allowance is represented.

06 • Client: Please ask them, because I don't want the finished cupboard width quietly increased.

07 • Carpenter: I'll ask for separate supplied and finished dimensions on this panel's confirmation drawing.

08 • Client: Can we keep the agreed cabinet face line as the reference in that question?

09 • Carpenter: Yes, I'll name that line explicitly and attach the elevation you already approved.

10 • Client: Then the question is about interpreting the allowance, not approving a larger cupboard today.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A cloud on the drawing

A carpenter and site coordinator identify the actual extent of a revised drawing.

01 • Carpenter: The latest elevation has a revision cloud around the upper shelves. Did the base change?

02 • Site coordinator: The issue note mentions shelf spacing only, but let's check the revision description together.

03 • Carpenter: Our earlier base detail still appears in the folder beside this new elevation.

04 • Site coordinator: That's possible; not every sheet was reissued. Which base dimension are you concerned about?

05 • Carpenter: The drawer front height. I don't see a changed dimension or a corresponding note.

06 • Site coordinator: Then we shouldn't assume the cloud changes that height merely because it's nearby.

07 • Carpenter: Could you confirm the current sheet list so the workshop uses the right combination?

08 • Site coordinator: Yes. I'll identify the reissued elevation and the retained base detail on the transmittal.

09 • Carpenter: I'll tell the workshop that shelf spacing changed, while base-height clarification remains separate.

10 • Site coordinator: Good. That prevents a partial drawing issue from being interpreted as an entirely new cabinet.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

Cabinet elevation C4 revision B shows a 20-millimeter reveal. Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters at the same end panel. Fabrication release is due for review at 14:00. The designer has not clarified which dimension applies.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the designer. Ask for the two drawing references and the affected component.

Second round: You can answer only at 15:00. Agree how the panel's release status will be described at the 14:00 review.

Scenario 2 | The detail says typical

A drawing labels a 10-millimeter reveal typical. A separate pantry elevation shows a 6-millimeter reveal. Both are current; neither names an exception.

Role A: Carpenter: ask whether the pantry is an exception.

Role B: Designer: you can review the pantry relationship but cannot answer from memory.

Possible opening: Does the typical reveal apply at the pantry, or is that elevation a deliberate exception?

Success checks

- Cite both details.
- Explain that typical does not resolve a stated conflict.
- Agree the pantry item remains pending clarification.

Add a complication: The site manager wants the carpenter to choose the larger dimension for consistency.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A stain is not a joist assessment

At the laundry doorway, a carpenter answers the client's question about staining.

01 • Carpenter: There's dark staining on the exposed subfloor beside the laundry doorway in this area.

02 • Client: Does that mean the joists underneath are rotten and the whole floor needs replacing?

03 • Carpenter: I can't conclude that. The joists aren't visible, and their condition hasn't been assessed.

04 • Client: We had a washing-machine spill years ago. Could that explain what you're seeing now?

05 • Carpenter: It could be relevant history, but I can't confirm the cause from the stain.

06 • Client: Please include the spill when you speak to the project lead about the assessment.

07 • Carpenter: I will describe it as your recollection, separately from the visible staining we see.

08 • Client: Will that assessment also tell us whether any change to the agreed work is needed?

09 • Carpenter: The assessment can clarify this concealed condition before we discuss a revised carpentry scope.

10 • Client: All right. I'd rather understand the finding than approve replacement based on appearance alone.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The photograph does not show the support

A carpenter and project lead discuss an incomplete site photograph.

01 • Carpenter: The client's photograph shows the new shelf location, but not what's behind the wall.

02 • Project lead: They're asking whether the existing blocking can support the cabinet at that position.

03 • Carpenter: We don't have a verified record of blocking there, so the photograph cannot answer.

04 • Project lead: Is there an earlier framing record we can request from the original contractor first?

05 • Carpenter: Yes, I'll ask for that record and identify which wall and cabinet position we mean.

06 • Project lead: Please don't describe the missing record as evidence that no blocking exists at all.

07 • Carpenter: Agreed. I'll say the support arrangement remains unverified, rather than absent or inadequate.

08 • Project lead: The client also wants a fixed installation date. What can we tell them today?

09 • Carpenter: We can give the current planning status and explain which assessment the date depends on.

10 • Project lead: I'll handle that conversation and keep the support question separate from our scheduling preference.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A small gap with no agreed tolerance

A carpenter discusses a reported trim gap with the client's representative.

01 • Carpenter: You noted a gap at the stair trim. Which joint are you referring to?

02 • Client representative: The upper corner beside the landing. I photographed it this morning from the hallway.

03 • Carpenter: Thank you. Do we have an agreed sample or acceptance detail for that joint?

04 • Client representative: There's an approved detail, but I haven't compared the photograph with it yet.

05 • Carpenter: Then let's identify the location and request a comparison before calling it acceptable or defective.

06 • Client representative: The owner asked me whether every gap of that size is always a defect.

07 • Carpenter: I wouldn't give a universal answer. The detail and actual condition matter for this review.

08 • Client representative: I'll send the photograph with the drawing reference, without presenting my impression as a finding.

09 • Carpenter: Please also note the viewing location so the reviewer understands what the image shows.

10 • Client representative: Done. We'll describe it as a reported finish concern pending comparison with the agreed detail.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

An existing exposed subfloor has dark staining beside the laundry doorway. The client asks whether the joists are rotten. The carpenter has not assessed structural condition and the joists are not visible. The project lead can arrange a qualified assessment.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. Ask whether visible staining necessarily means structural decay.

Second round: The client remembers an old spill. Attribute that recollection without treating it as the confirmed explanation.

Scenario 2 | A ceiling mark reported after delivery

A homeowner notices a ceiling mark above the hallway-to-study doorway after cabinet delivery through that doorway. No before-photo covers the area. The route is known, but the cause of the mark is not.

Role A: Carpenter: acknowledge the concern and distinguish timing from established cause.

Role B: Homeowner: you noticed the mark at 16:00 and want it reviewed.

Possible opening: I understand why the timing concerns you; can we identify exactly where the mark is?

Success checks

- Acknowledge the concern without blaming anyone.
- State the observation time and missing evidence.
- Agree who will review the mark and report back.

Add a complication: The homeowner asks you to confirm that the delivery crew caused it.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The bench is an addition

A carpenter and bedroom client discuss the requested bench.

01 • Carpenter: The bedroom quotation covers skirting, or baseboard, replacement. The bench would be additional work.

02 • Client: I thought there might be room in the price because it's quite small.

03 • Carpenter: We haven't agreed its dimensions or storage arrangement, so I can't price it yet.

04 • Client: Could you get a separate quotation without changing the skirting work already agreed?

05 • Carpenter: Yes. We also need to clarify making good, because decorating is currently excluded.

06 • Client: I'd like a painted finish, with space underneath for two storage boxes.

07 • Carpenter: Please give us the box dimensions so that requirement is clear in the enquiry.

08 • Client: Does asking for the quotation mean I have committed to buying the bench?

09 • Carpenter: No. A change order would record any agreed alteration after you consider the price and timing.

10 • Client: Then obtain that comparison, and keep the existing bedroom scope unchanged for now.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Painting around the new frame

A carpenter and homeowner clarify restoration around a replacement frame.

01 • Carpenter: The frame proposal mentions making good locally. What finish were you expecting?

02 • Homeowner: I assumed the whole wall would be repainted so no difference would show.

03 • Carpenter: The quotation doesn't define that extent clearly. Let's clarify it before accepting the scope.

04 • Homeowner: Can you explain the difference between local making good and decorating the wall?

05 • Carpenter: Local work concerns disturbed areas; whole-wall decoration is a broader item to price.

06 • Homeowner: Then I'd like both extents described, because appearance matters more than a vague allowance.

07 • Carpenter: I'll ask the estimator to identify the surfaces and finish standard for each option.

08 • Homeowner: Please include the return beside the doorway; it's easy to overlook from this room.

09 • Carpenter: I'll name it separately so we can see whether each quotation includes it.

10 • Homeowner: Good. We'll decide from those descriptions instead of assuming the word locally covers everything.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A verbal suggestion becomes a request

A carpenter checks a shelving conversation with a tenant representative.

01 • Carpenter: Yesterday you mentioned another shelf above the desk. Was that a suggestion or request?

02 • Tenant representative: A request for a price, not approval to add it to the order.

03 • Carpenter: Thanks. The workshop heard add a shelf and asked me for fabrication dimensions.

04 • Tenant representative: Please tell them to hold that addition. The facilities manager approves extra costs here.

05 • Carpenter: I'll keep the approved shelving separate and request a price for the additional piece.

06 • Tenant representative: Can the quotation also say whether the extra shelf changes the delivery timing?

07 • Carpenter: Yes, that question belongs in the comparison rather than being assumed unchanged.

08 • Tenant representative: The facilities manager is available Thursday. I can discuss the priced option then.

09 • Carpenter: I'll label it quotation requested, with your review meeting noted as the next decision point.

10 • Tenant representative: That reflects what I intended and avoids the workshop treating a conversation as approval.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Separating requested extras from agreed work

The agreed bedroom scope includes replacing skirting only. The client requests a built-in bench; decorating is excluded. The carpenter can arrange a separate quotation, but no bench dimensions, price, or completion date are agreed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. You want storage in the bench but have not chosen its size.

Second round: The client adds matching wall paneling. Identify it as another item to assess, not an assumed part of the bench.

Scenario 2 | Who supplies the handles?

A wardrobe quotation includes fitting handles but excludes their supply. The client has selected handles online but has not ordered them. The supplier's delivery date is unknown.

Role A: Carpenter: explain supply versus fitting and ask who will arrange delivery.

Role B: Client: you assumed the carpenter would buy the selected handles.

Possible opening: The quote includes fitting the handles; can we confirm who is supplying them?

Success checks

- Distinguish supply from fitting.
- Agree who will check the selected product and delivery.
- Keep completion timing conditional on confirmed information.

Add a complication: The client wants the original completion date confirmed before supplier availability is checked.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Delivery is ready, the room is not

A carpenter updates the site coordinator about Tuesday's joinery.

01 • Carpenter: Tuesday's joinery delivery is confirmed, but the decorator hasn't released the study yet.

02 • Site coordinator: Could the crew use the hallway while we sort out access to the study?

03 • Carpenter: The hallway window is for an eleven o'clock trim review, not storage or fitting.

04 • Site coordinator: Thanks for separating those. I'll ask the decorator when the study can be released.

05 • Carpenter: I'll check delivery flexibility with the supplier rather than assume materials can stay elsewhere.

06 • Site coordinator: Please don't cancel the delivery until we know both options and their consequences.

07 • Carpenter: Agreed. I'll ask what's possible and bring the response back before changing anything.

08 • Site coordinator: The decorator has just offered Wednesday morning. Does that resolve the whole sequence?

09 • Carpenter: It resolves the proposed access window, but supplier timing and crew availability still need checking.

10 • Site coordinator: I'll show Wednesday as proposed in the lookahead schedule, with those two dependencies open.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The countertop appointment moves

A carpenter and kitchen coordinator discuss a revised supplier visit.

01 • Carpenter: The countertop surveyor moved their appointment to Thursday. Does the current cabinet review still work?

02 • Kitchen coordinator: Our cabinet review was Friday, so the surveyor would arrive before that review.

03 • Carpenter: Then we need to reconcile the sequence rather than tell both teams they're confirmed.

04 • Kitchen coordinator: Can your review move to Wednesday afternoon, or is that still unconfirmed?

05 • Carpenter: Wednesday is possible for me, but the client needs to attend the appearance review.

06 • Kitchen coordinator: I'll ask the client about Wednesday and explain why the timing matters for Thursday.

07 • Carpenter: Please distinguish the appearance review from the surveyor's own measurement and acceptance requirements.

08 • Kitchen coordinator: I will. Moving our meeting doesn't automatically mean their survey prerequisites are satisfied.

09 • Carpenter: Once both parties confirm their requirements, we can update the lookahead with real dependencies.

10 • Kitchen coordinator: I'll contact them today and keep Thursday tentative until the sequence is agreed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The retained floor needs a clear boundary

A carpenter and homeowner discuss access through an occupied room.

01 • Carpenter: Our agreed route passes through the sitting room. Which furniture will remain in place?

02 • Homeowner: The piano stays, and the desk must remain usable during my afternoon appointments.

03 • Carpenter: Then we need the protection plan and access window to reflect both constraints.

04 • Homeowner: Can your crew simply use the side doorway whenever the front room is busy?

05 • Carpenter: That route wasn't reviewed. I'll ask the site coordinator to assess it before agreeing.

06 • Homeowner: Please explain that I need quiet from one until three, not all afternoon.

07 • Carpenter: I'll state those hours precisely and ask whether the planned sequence can accommodate them.

08 • Homeowner: That sounds workable. Can we have one contact for confirming any daily access changes?

09 • Carpenter: The site coordinator can handle those confirmations; I'll make sure your constraint reaches them.

10 • Homeowner: Thank you. I can plan my appointments around a confirmed window, not an informal guess.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Coordinating access and other trades

The joinery delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning. The decorator has not released the study for carpentry access. The hallway is available for a separate trim review at 11:00, but not for material storage. The site coordinator needs the current status.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the coordinator. Confirm the delivery but ask which area is actually available.

Second round: The decorator releases the study for Wednesday morning. Discuss what still needs checking with the supplier.

Scenario 2 | The lift booking belongs to another crew

A cabinet delivery is proposed for 10:00. The service lift is booked for another trade from 09:30 to 11:00. The building manager can offer 11:30, subject to supplier agreement.

Role A: Carpenter: explain the conflict and propose checking the later slot.

Role B: Building manager: keep the existing booking and offer 11:30 for confirmation.

Possible opening: Our proposed delivery overlaps the booked lift window; is eleven thirty available for us?

Success checks

- Name the conflicting windows.
- Avoid claiming the later slot is final before both sides agree.
- Confirm the delivery and lift booking together.

Add a complication: The supplier can deliver at 11:30 but cannot provide storage before then.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

I overlooked drawer D3

A carpenter repairs an inaccurate statement during a wardrobe review.

01 • Carpenter: I said all the fronts were flush, but you've identified an exception at D3.

02 • Client: Yes, the left edge projects beyond the next front when viewed from here.

03 • Carpenter: You're right about that visible relationship. My earlier statement was too broad.

04 • Client: Can we put that exact location on the snag list rather than cabinet alignment?

05 • Carpenter: Certainly. I'll describe D3's left edge projecting beyond the neighboring front for review.

06 • Client: Do you know whether the drawer front needs replacing, or just an adjustment?

07 • Carpenter: I haven't established the cause or remedy. The joinery lead needs to review it.

08 • Client: They offered Thursday morning. Can you confirm that appointment without promising completion that day?

09 • Carpenter: Yes, I'll confirm the review appointment and leave the remedy and completion date open.

10 • Client: Good. That gives us a specific follow-up instead of another general statement about the wardrobe.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Level and plumb are different questions

A carpenter and client discuss wording in a finish-review note.

01 • Carpenter: Your review note says the tall panel isn't level. Which direction concerns you?

02 • Client: It seems to lean sideways when I compare its edge with the doorway.

03 • Carpenter: For that vertical relationship, plumb is the more precise term than level.

04 • Client: Thanks. I wasn't sure how to describe the leaning without using the wrong word.

05 • Carpenter: We can say the vertical edge appears out of plumb and request a check.

06 • Client: Does appears mean you're dismissing what I can see from the hall?

07 • Carpenter: No. It preserves your observation while distinguishing it from a completed measurement or assessment.

08 • Client: Then include my viewing position so the joinery lead can examine the same concern.

09 • Carpenter: I will. The review should address that panel, not every cabinet in the room.

10 • Client: That is the item I meant; the revised wording makes the concern much clearer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The agreed sample covers sheen

A carpenter and owner compare a finished panel with an acceptance sample.

01 • Carpenter: The acceptance sample records sheen and color. Which feature differs on this installed panel?

02 • Owner: The sheen looks similar, but there's a grain patch I don't like near the handle.

03 • Carpenter: That is a separate appearance concern. The sample note doesn't establish a grain-pattern guarantee.

04 • Owner: I understand wood varies, but I'd still like someone to review the visible patch.

05 • Carpenter: Of course. I'll record its location and your concern without saying the sample settles it.

06 • Owner: Please don't mark the whole panel accepted just because the sheen matches our reference.

07 • Carpenter: I'll keep the grain concern open and distinguish it from the matched sheen.

08 • Owner: Could the supplier show what variation was described when we selected this material?

09 • Carpenter: Yes, I'll request that information for the review, alongside the panel and sample references.

10 • Owner: Then we can discuss the specific concern with the right information rather than argue over match.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

At a wardrobe review you said all fronts were flush. The client points to drawer D3, whose left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. You have not assessed the cause or remedy. Correct your earlier statement and add the specific observation for follow-up.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. Identify D3's left edge and ask that it remain visible in the snag record.

Second round: The joinery lead cannot attend until Thursday. Agree the review appointment without promising a same-day remedy.

Scenario 2 | An item is done but not checked

A snag list, also called a punch list, has five trim items. Items 1 and 2, the hall baseboard and study casing, are completed and reviewed. Items 3 and 4, the pantry return and window joint, are reported complete but not client-reviewed. Item 5, the store-door molding, awaits replacement.

Role A: Carpenter: separate completed work, reviewed items, and the pending replacement.

Role B: Client: you can review items 3 and 4, the pantry return and window joint, at 15:00.

Possible opening: Four items are reported complete, but you have reviewed only two so far.

Success checks

- Give the three different statuses.
- Confirm which two items will be reviewed at 15:00.
- Keep the replacement item open.

Add a complication: The client suggests marking all five closed before the afternoon visit.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Friday is the call, not the visit

A carpenter hands over cabinet documents to the owner.

01 • Carpenter: Here are the cabinet drawings and the care sheet for the finish actually supplied.

02 • Owner: Thank you. The shelf pin cover is missing; is that still on your list?

03 • Carpenter: Yes, it remains outstanding. Mina has accepted supplier follow-up and will call you Friday.

04 • Owner: Does that mean someone will arrive Friday to fit the cover in the cabinet?

05 • Carpenter: No, Friday is the update date. The cover hasn't arrived, so attendance isn't confirmed.

06 • Owner: Please make that distinction clear; I need notice before taking time off work.

07 • Carpenter: I'll record your need for notice and ask Mina to agree any visit directly.

08 • Owner: Can you also explain whether the warranty covers every mark on the finish?

09 • Carpenter: The supplied document states its terms. I shouldn't replace those with a broad verbal promise.

10 • Owner: Understood. I'll keep it with the care sheet and expect Mina's status call Friday.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The manual belongs to the old hardware

A carpenter and client identify a mismatched handover leaflet.

01 • Carpenter: You've found a different hinge model on the leaflet. Let's compare the product references.

02 • Client: The installed hardware was changed during procurement, but this leaflet shows the first selection.

03 • Carpenter: Then the handover pack needs correction. Please keep this copy separate from the applicable information.

04 • Client: Can you obtain the correct document without asking me to identify the replacement myself?

05 • Carpenter: Yes. I'll use the recorded supply reference and request the matching leaflet from the supplier.

06 • Client: I'd like the as-built record to show that hardware substitution accurately for future enquiries.

07 • Carpenter: I'll ask the joinery lead to reconcile the record with the confirmed supplied product.

08 • Client: Will you send a complete corrected pack or only the new individual page?

09 • Carpenter: A complete identified pack will be clearer, with the superseded document noted in the covering message.

10 • Client: Good. I can then keep one reliable set instead of guessing which loose sheet applies.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A callback needs a specific description

A carpenter clarifies a client's request for a return visit.

01 • Carpenter: Your message asks us to come back about the cupboard. What has changed?

02 • Client: The upper left door rubs the neighboring front when I open it now.

03 • Carpenter: When did you first notice that, and is this the cupboard beside the window?

04 • Client: Yesterday evening, and yes, the window cupboard. The other doors seem unchanged to me.

05 • Carpenter: I'll record that description and arrange a review rather than suggest an adjustment by phone.

06 • Client: Thank you. I don't want to alter the hardware myself and complicate the review.

07 • Carpenter: The service coordinator can offer appointment windows. May they contact you on this number?

08 • Client: Yes, afternoons are easiest, except Wednesday when the room is being used for meetings.

09 • Carpenter: I'll pass on those availability limits and keep the item identified as a reported concern.

10 • Client: Please do. A defined review appointment will help more than a promise to drop by sometime.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handing over records and return visits

The owner receives cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet. A replacement shelf pin cover is due but not delivered. The joinery lead, Mina, accepts supplier follow-up and will call Friday. The return-visit date is not confirmed; warranty terms remain those in the supplied document.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the owner. Ask who will follow up and whether Friday is an installation date.

Second round: The supplier changes the expected delivery. Explain the revised status without interpreting warranty coverage.

Scenario 2 | The named contact is away

The owner expects a Friday update about replacement drawer front D6. Its delivery date is unconfirmed. Mina is away; colleague Joel can accept supplier follow-up but has not yet spoken to the supplier.

Role A: Outgoing carpenter: ask Joel to accept the follow-up and distinguish known status from an expected reply.

Role B: Joel: you can contact the supplier today and call the owner Friday regardless of whether a date is confirmed.

Possible opening: Can you take over the drawer-front follow-up while Mina is away?

Success checks

- Confirm Joel accepts the task.
- Preserve the unknown delivery status.
- Keep Friday as an update, not a delivery promise.

Add a complication: The owner asks whether the change of contact means the part has arrived.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Original fictional language practice, not carpentry instruction, structural assessment, legal advice, or a statement of code or permit requirements. All dimensions, incidents, quotations, products, and schedules in exercises are invented. Structural decisions, hazardous materials, tool use, installation methods, and site safety require qualified people and project-specific procedures. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of these cases.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Carpenters

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/construction-and-extraction/carpenters.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Carpenters (47-2031.00), U.S. Department of Labor-sponsored occupational profile

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/47-2031.00>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Carpentry & Remodeling English

Professional audience: Carpenters, remodelers, finish carpenters, joinery installers, and carpentry crew leads

Scope: Original fictional language practice, not carpentry instruction, structural assessment, legal advice, or a statement of code or permit requirements. All dimensions, incidents, quotations, products, and schedules in exercises are invented. Structural decisions, hazardous materials, tool use, installation methods, and site safety require qualified people and project-specific procedures. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of these cases.

Dialogue 01: The survey note and the door schedule

Original fictional setting: A carpenter and designer reconcile references for a utility-room door without selecting an installation method.

Professional roles: Carpenter / Designer

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Carpenter: The utility door schedule shows a unit width, while the survey labels an opening. Can we reconcile them?

Designer: Yes. Which drawing revision and survey location are you using for that comparison this morning?

Carpenter: Revision C, doorway U2. The survey was taken before the wall finishes were added on either side.

Designer: Then the survey dimension describes an earlier condition. The schedule refers to the proposed door unit itself.

Carpenter: The client has asked for the usable passage width, so neither number answers that question directly.

Designer: Correct. We need the completed opening relationship, including the selected frame, before confirming usable width to them.

Carpenter: Could you issue a marked detail identifying the datum and the surfaces for each dimension?

Designer: I can prepare that clarification. Please keep the supplier's order on hold while I reconcile the documents.

Carpenter: I will. Should I tell the client the proposed door is unsuitable for their delivery trolley?

Designer: Not yet; suitability hasn't been established either way. Ask for the trolley's actual dimensions and turning requirements.

Carpenter: They can provide those today. I'll identify them as client requirements, not alter your drawing myself.

Designer: Good. Send them with the survey, and we'll answer the passage question against one coordinated detail.

Vocabulary in this exchange: datum: An agreed reference point or line from which project dimensions are measured.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
 2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
 3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
 4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
 5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.
- Use voice replies when available. If I prefer selections, offer four plausible spoken replies and explain my choice before continuing. Do not require written compositions.

END PROMPT

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

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When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

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Designer: Good. Send them with the survey, and we'll answer the passage question against one coordinated detail.

Vocabulary in this exchange: datum: An agreed reference point or line from which project dimensions are measured.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT